

Unix Computing Society at RIT

Effective 2025-08-09

SECTION I: NAME

The name of this organization shall be the Unix Computing Society at RIT (RUCS).

SECTION II: PURPOSE

The purpose of the organization is to foster a collaborative environment for the RIT community to enrich their understanding of Unix and its place in the software world.

SECTION III: MEMBERSHIP

- i. Membership is open to regularly enrolled undergraduates, post graduates, faculty, staff, and night students.
- ii. Active members shall be defined as those in good standing who have met the qualifications set forth in the Club and Organization Recognition Guidelines. Only active members are eligible to vote in elections.
- iii. A member shall be declared inactive if he/she attends fewer than forty percent of the official club activities within a given academic term. Exception is made for members on co-op, the summer term, and intersession.

SECTION IV: MEETINGS

- i. At a minimum, one meeting shall be held per week when classes are in session.
- ii. Meetings will generally be structured as a presentation, with a member of the club presenting a subject of their choice.

SECTION V: OFFICERS

- i. The duties of the officers in this organization shall be in order of rank: President, Vice-President, Secretary, Treasurer, and Executive Board Member(s). RUCS (and Executive Board) may choose to rename these positions.
- ii. Qualifications for office shall be to maintain good academic standing as defined by RIT (not on academic probation). In order to be nominated for office, member must have been active in the club during the previous academic term (not including the summer term and intersession), as defined in Membership.
- iii. Officers shall be elected in the manner provided in the constitution and shall serve one calendar year beginning after elections. Officers are eligible for re-election.
- iv. No officer may hold more than one office simultaneously, although they may take on the responsibilities of another office if the need is present either during the year or at election time.
- v. An officer may resign from office by submitting the intention in writing to the Executive Board. The resignation becomes effective upon submission to the Executive Board. Upon resignation, the University must be informed.
- vi. The Executive Board may appoint new officers and create new positions as they see fit, by unanimous vote.

SECTION VI: ADVISORS

- i. There shall be at least one club advisor.
- ii. Only RIT staff and faculty are qualified to become an advisor, unless with permission of the Associate Director of Student Clubs and Organizations and or the Club Review Board.
- iii. If the club advisor resigns, the university must be informed.
- iv. The duty of the advisor shall be to ensure that the club follows Institute rules and regulations, assist and advise the Executive Board on decisions, and nurture the club's development.

SECTION VII: DUTIES OF OFFICERS

I: PRESIDENT

- i. Preside over all meetings and activities of the organization, and the Executive Board.
- ii. Attend all general club meetings, designating an alternative member to attend meetings in the President's absence.

II: VICE PRESIDENT

- i. Take over the duties of the President when needed or in the temporary absence of the President.
- ii. Supervise all financial transactions of the organization and keep all financial records.
- iii. Maintain regular contact with the Secretary of Finance of Student Government if needed.

III: SECRETARY

- i. Take over the duties of the Vice President in the temporary absence of the Vice President.
- ii. Keep an accurate roll of members and keep the minutes of all meetings.
- iii. Be responsible for maintaining and updating all paperwork.
- iv. Maintain all internal club policies and documentation.

IV: TREASURER

- i. Handle incoming donations of any form to the club.
- ii. Manage the club budget, including budget requests and club payments.
- iii. Be responsible for the financial upkeep of club property (such as recurring payments on services).
- iv. Advise the RUCS Executive Board on financial matters, proactively where appropriate and on request of Executive Board officers.

SECTION VIII: EXECUTIVE BOARD

- i. The management of this organization shall be vested in the Executive Board.
- ii. The Executive Board shall be composed of the President, Vice-President, Secretary, Advisor(s), Treasurer, and Executive Board members, or equivalent titles if appropriate.
- iii. The Executive Board shall meet and report information to members as needed.
- iv. The Executive Board shall hold a special election to fill a sudden vacancy of any office.

SECTION IX: RECORD KEEPING

- i. The Executive Board shall maintain and keep updated a record of club history, including Executive Board members and notable club happenings.
- ii. The Executive Board shall maintain meeting notes on Executive Board proceedings.
- iii. The Executive Board shall make available on request club history and past records, excluding information deemed confidential, to RIT and active club members.
- iv. The Executive Board shall maintain and keep updated records on how the club operates and how to manage club property and proceedings.

SECTION X: ELECTIONS

- i. Nominations for office shall be made from the floor at the meeting prior to the election meeting by any member in good standing. A person may be nominated for more than one office.
- ii. The order of election shall be President, Vice-President, Secretary, Treasurer, and Executive Board Members.
- iii. Votes shall be cast by secret ballot, with an exception made for write-ins.
- iv. Elections shall be scheduled no less than one week in advance, during a regularly scheduled club meeting.
- v. Elections shall take place no less than three weeks prior to the end of the semester to allow for a transitional period.
- vi. Induction of new officers shall take place at the meeting after elections.

SECTION XI: TRANSFER OF ACCOUNTS

- i. The term "Superuser" shall refer to an account with the highest possible level of permissions. In the case of a Unix-based or Unix-like operating system, this refers specifically to the user account with ID 1.
- ii. Superuser passwords for all RUCS-owned devices (e.g. servers) must be given to the new President before the meeting subsequent to the election meeting.
- iii. Any online account which is created for the sole purpose of serving RUCS, not including accounts on the behalf of any one member of RUCS, must be recoverable with the services that are provided by RUCS's status as a club (e.g. `RUCS@rit.edu`).
- iv. Any online organization (e.g. GitHub organization, subreddit, IRC) which is created to represent RUCS must contain one of the above accounts with superuser privileges.

SECTION XII: IMPEACHMENT

- i. Any officer of this organization can be impeached.
- ii. Impeachment may be initiated by petition, in writing, by 25% or more of the active members, when presented to the members in a regular meeting.
- iii. At the next meeting, the impeached officer shall present their defense to the members, then a secret ballot vote shall be taken.
- iv. Conviction of impeachment shall require a 2/3 vote by the active members in good standing present.
- v. Conviction of impeachment shall cause removal from office and loss of all privileges thereof.

- vi. The filling of an office vacated by impeachment shall be by a special election held in the manner of annual elections.
- vii. The Executive Board reserves the right to remove an officer by unanimous vote, excluding the offending officer, with the consent of the Advisor.

SECTION XIII: AMENDMENTS

- i. An amendment to this constitution may be proposed by any member in good standing, in writing, at any meeting. A copy of the amendment must be made easily accessible by club members for at least two weeks before a vote takes place.
- ii. The proposed amendment shall require a 2/3 affirmative vote by a voting quorum made up of active members.
- iii. Before the proposed amendment shall become operational it must be approved by the Associate Director of Student Clubs and Organizations.

SECTION XIV: ADHERENCE TO UNIVERSITY POLICIES

I: ANTI-HAZING

- i. Per the RIT Hazing Policy (RIT Student Conduct Process; IV. RIT Code of Conduct; 14. Hazing/Failure to Report Hazing) Hazing/Failure to Report Hazing. Behavior, regardless of intent, which endangers the emotional, or physical health and safety of a Student for the purpose of membership, affiliation with, or maintaining membership in, a group or Student Organization. Hazing includes any level of participation, such as being in the presence, having awareness of hazing, or failing to report hazing. Examples of hazing include, but are not limited to, beating or branding, sleep deprivation or causing excessive fatigue, threats of harm, forcing or coercing consumption of food, water, alcohol or other drugs, or other substances, verbal abuse, embarrassing, humiliating, or degrading acts, or activities that induce, cause or require the Student to perform a duty or task which is not consistent with fraternal law, ritual or policy or involves a violation of local, state or federal laws, or the RIT Code of Conduct.

II: NY STATE HAZING LAW

- i. § 120.16 Hazing in the first degree. A person is guilty of hazing in the first degree when, in the course of another person's initiation into or affiliation with any organization, he intentionally or recklessly engages in conduct which creates a substantial risk of physical injury to such other person or a third person and thereby causes such injury. Hazing in the first degree is a class A misdemeanor.
- ii. § 120.17 Hazing in the second degree. A person is guilty of hazing in the second degree when, in the course of another person's initiation or affiliation with any organization, he intentionally or recklessly engages in conduct which creates a substantial risk of physical injury to such other person or a third person. Hazing in the second degree is a violation.

III: ANTI-DISCRIMINATION CLAUSE

- i. This organization shall not discriminate on the basis of sex, race, color, sexual orientation gender identity and gender expression, religion, age marital sate, national origin, disability or veteran status. This policy will include but is not limited to, recruiting, membership, organization activities or opportunities to hold or run for club office.

IV: STATEMENT OF COMPLIANCE WITH UNIVERSITY REGULATIONS

- i. This organization shall comply with all university and Center for Campus Life policies and regulations, and local, state and federal laws.

SECTION XV: ENABLING CLAUSE

- i. This constitution was voted on and put into effect on 2025-08-09.
- ii. This document has been signed by:
 - 1. President: Nathan Strobl
 - 2. Treasurer: Christopher Fore
 - 3. Advisor: Larry Kiser